

Adobe University Hackathon 2026

Case 09 | AuraWear (DTC Apparel)

D2C apparel strong on SEO but invisible or misrepresented in AI shopping answers

Industry: DTC apparel / E-commerce | Theme: Speak to Agents - Brand Visibility

Practice paper | Timebox 45:00 | Suggested: read 5 | Q1-Q4 as marked | buffer 2

Unofficial - for team practice only. Official Round 2 may differ.

Scenario

AuraWear is a mid-size Indian D2C apparel brand. Classic SEO is fine: many category pages rank on page 1 for 'organic cotton tees', 'workwear shirts women', etc. Monthly organic sessions are stable.

But when shoppers ask AI assistants things like 'best sustainable everyday wear brands in India under 2000 INR' or 'good formal shirts for college placements', ChatGPT / Perplexity / Gemini often recommend 3-4 competitors and never mention AuraWear. When AuraWear does appear, the answer misstates pricing and calls it a 'premium luxury' brand.

Competitor NovaKnit dominates AI answers via Quora threads, review roundups, and a stronger third-party footprint.

Case facts / data

- robots.txt blocks several AI crawlers; CDN returns 403 to unknown bots on /collections/*.
- Product pages are heavily client-rendered (JS). Key specs sit behind tabs.
- Blog last major refresh: 11 months ago. Few FAQ blocks in natural Q&A form.
- Wikipedia page is a stub. Reddit / Quora mentions are rare vs Competitor NovaKnit.
- Sample prompt board (20 prompts): AuraWear mention rate 15%, citation rate 5%, avg sentiment mixed/negative on price. NovaKnit mention rate 60%, citation 35%.
- Analytics shows almost no agentic bot hits on PDP URLs; a few hits on old blog posts.
- Top losing cluster: sustainable everyday wear under 2000 + placement formals. Rare win: branded AuraWear prompts only.

Questions

Question 1 (8-10 min)

What are the top 3 reasons AuraWear is invisible or misrepresented in AI-generated answers despite decent SEO? Separate technical, content, and offsite/earned-media causes. Tie each to a case fact.

Question 2 (7-8 min)

Design a simple measurement plan for the next 8 weeks. Which metrics would you track across AI platforms, how often, and how would you know if the brand is actually winning visibility (not just traffic)?

Question 3 (10-12 min)

Propose a prioritized 30-day action plan (quick wins vs deeper work) for onsite and offsite GEO. Be specific. Tie each action to your diagnosis in Q1. Call out one thing you would NOT do first.

Question 4 (8-10 min)

AuraWear's growth lead wants an agent-era brand visibility workflow (monitor prompts -> find gaps -> fix content -> prove impact). Outline the workflow and what a tool like Adobe Brand Visibility (or a student-built agent) should automate vs leave to humans.

Answer frame (use on every question)

- One-line bottom line first
- 2-3 causes tied to case facts (do not invent numbers)
- Prioritized actions: quick wins vs later bets
- Metrics / how you know it worked
- Optional one-line Adobe / agent angle if it fits

Judged on: analytical thinking, strategic approach, actionable insights. Write like a sharp student analyst under time

pressure - specific, not buzzwordy.

Team tip: attempt alone under timer, then compare notes. Focus debate on prioritization and metrics - not who wrote longer answers.